

Speaker 1 [00:00:00] Yes, let him start recording. To confirm that you have read the consent form, that you are voluntarily participating in this research-

Speaker 2 [00:00:10] I understand.

Speaker 1 [00:00:11] Can you confirm?

Speaker 2 [00:00:13] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:00:15] Do you confirm?

Speaker 2 [00:00:17] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:00:19] Uh, do you mind if I take notes?

Speaker 2 [00:00:22] Doing what?

Speaker 1 [00:00:23] Do you mind if I take notes?

Speaker 2 [00:00:25] No, there is no harm.

Speaker 1 [00:00:29] I have a group of questions for you. Uh, you can talk as you like, you can say whatever you like. We expect our interview to last about an hour, give or take. It could be 45 minutes, it could be an hour and 15 minutes. We will explore it together. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:48] [50-55].

Speaker 1 [00:00:51] How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:53] Uh, about [26-30] years.

Speaker 1 [00:00:59] Do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:01:01] I do. I have [1-5] children.

Speaker 1 [00:01:06] How old are they?

Speaker 2 [00:01:08] One is [20-25], one is [20-25].

Speaker 1 [00:01:13] Who do you live with at home?

Speaker 2 [00:01:16] I live at home with my wife and [1-5] daughter at the moment.

Speaker 1 [00:01:25] What is your main source of income?

Speaker 2 [00:01:28] Uh our main source of income, I am retired. My husband is also retired now but he continues to work.

Speaker 1 [00:01:40] I address your husband as your husband, I will. If you prefer me to address in another way, I can address that way, that's why I am asking.

Speaker 2 [00:01:45] Okay, not at all, no need.

Speaker 1 [00:01:47] Okay. Would you like to tell me the story of how you met?

Speaker 2 [00:01:51] I'll tell you the story of how we met, of course. I mean, my husband and I got married in an arranged marriage. I was [20-25] years old. I mean, at that time, at a certain age, you know, you think about marriage a lot, it's hard to decide at that age. I was living in [City A], my husband was in [City B]. Then he came to [City A] to see me from there. But I wasn't looking at it positively at all. Then I talked to my husband one day. He said he would call me. You know, to think

it over and make a decision without being influenced by anyone. And I didn't even think about it, he's going to call me but what am I going to answer. And one day later my husband called me and asked me to marry me on the phone and I accepted the marriage proposal.

Speaker 1 [00:02:51] That was fast.

Speaker 2 [00:02:53] I didn't understand how it happened either, I didn't think about it. Then, [1#-5] month after that, he came with his family. So we had our promise and engagement. We got married about [1-5] months after the promise and engagement.

Speaker 1 [00:03:21] How did it happen so fast? How did it come to pass like this?

Speaker 2 [00:03:26] For me, when you look at it like this, there are some things that every young person goes through. After the relationships you have had before, you know, whether there will be a distrust of a man who comes across you or not. But when I saw my husband, for example, I never thought about it at that moment, but afterwards it was as if he made me forget everything else I had experienced. I can say that I fell in love with my husband the first time I saw him. It's either that or it's still like that. I mean, thank God, we are doing very well.

Speaker 1 [00:04:08] I'm glad. Your friend - how would you rate the quality of your relationship compared to the relationships of your friends, acquaintances, people around you?

Speaker 2 [00:04:20] If you say how do I evaluate the quality of my own relationship, yes, when I look at the people around me, you know, like an example, sometimes, under the pretext of coming up with something, some of my friends or people from my close circle are related to their spouses, you know, sometimes there are aspects that can even lead to violence, and I think that this way is. Okay, you know, there is no thing, you know, there is a man-woman thing. For example, it is said that everyone is free, there is no discrimination, but in fact it is not. Women? Not women, let's not say women, I mean both men and women should know how to say stop somewhere. I mean, they should know how to stop. So far, I think I've never had any problems between me and my husband. Yes, we've never had any bad sides, we've had some good sides. He is good in that way. I am patient. I mean, even if my husband is wrong, I don't go after him at that moment. I definitely don't. I wait for him to calm down. I mean, he doesn't get angry, but I keep quiet. After some time has passed, I would say to him in a calmer way, "You think this is how you think, but it's not really like that" and I have always done that. Because I know that if I went on him at that moment, he or I might say hurtful things to each other and hurt each other. So when I look at it, yes, I find my relationship better than the relationships around me. I find it good in this respect, so I told you.

Speaker 1 [00:06:10] On the one hand, you seem to be saying that you get bored better.

Speaker 2 [00:06:14] No, I don't get angry at that moment, actually, you know, maybe my anger, I don't know what we can say sometimes, I don't know anymore. You know, no matter how much the woman says yes, yes, yes, no matter how much the man says yes, but the woman makes them do what she says in a certain place in certain things. So this is the right thing. I think everything is mutual, I mean, I think everything is mutual after we can get along.

Speaker 1 [00:06:44] Then let me move on to that question. What are the things that make a relationship high quality?

Speaker 2 [00:06:52] Where?

Speaker 1 [00:06:53] What are the things that make a relationship high quality?

Speaker 2 [00:06:57] Things that do. First of all, I think it's trust. Trust and respect. I mean, because I know that if a person respects the other person, wherever there is respect, there is love (sevgi). Where there is trust, I mean, if I don't trust my spouse, what happens all the time, I will be in contradictions, or if my spouse doesn't trust me, if he is in contradictions, he will always try to look for something even in the smallest things. I think it is respect and trust that brings a relationship to the most extreme point.

Speaker 1 [00:07:40] So what makes it low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:07:41] Low quality? It's when people don't care about each other. That everybody is a little bit selfish, I should say, only thinking about themselves.

Speaker 1 [00:07:58] Selfishness and indifference.

Speaker 2 [00:08:01] Indifference, that's it, yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:08:03] Insensitivity.

Speaker 2 [00:08:04] Selfishness and indifference. Insecurity, exactly.

Speaker 1 [00:08:09] Can I ask you how many romantic relationships you had in the past? You said my wife - my wife made you forget them all.

Speaker 2 [00:08:18] Oh (laughs). My relationships in the past were, I mean, how can I say it? They were things that happened in childhood, I mean, sometimes maybe they were, uh, how do you say it? You know, one-sided ones. I had [1-5] serious relationship and I got a very big blow from it. And after that I closed myself off against men a lot. But let me put it this way, no matter what happens, it's okay for me. You know, from my husband, my husband also knew this, one of my close others got married with him, and one day I never forget, we were newly married. When my husband came home, he told me that he saw that person and he said he thanked him for leaving me to himself. At that moment, I mean for me it was as if everything in my life was gone, it was already gone, but at that moment I became something more. Oh, the others, I mean, I don't mean that- I mean, how can I tell you? Relationships definitely happen, but nothing very serious happened. That was the most serious one. In that one, as I said, I was hit by a blow.

Speaker 1 [00:09:39] How would you rate the quality of your current relationship compared to your previous relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:09:45] I cannot evaluate the quality.

Speaker 1 [00:09:51] Can you explain a little bit?

Speaker 2 [00:09:53] Sir?

Speaker 1 [00:09:54] Could you elaborate?

Speaker 2 [00:09:56] I mean, it's not like it can be explained, but you know, there is something like this now, they say love is lived, it cannot be explained.

Speaker 1 [00:10:08] Hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:10:09] I mean.

Speaker 1 [00:10:10] Am I hearing it right?

Speaker 2 [00:10:10] Right now I'm very much with my husband- sir?

Speaker 1 [00:10:13] Here you go.

Speaker 2 [00:10:15] I mean, I'm very happy with my husband right now. I'm very happy with him. I mean, if I were born again, I would want to be with the same husband in the same way.

Speaker 1 [00:10:29] You seem to be saying that there is no comparison.

Speaker 2 [00:10:30] Sir?

Speaker 1 [00:10:33] You seem to be saying that there is no comparison.

Speaker 2 [00:10:36] So. It's been a whole [20-25] years, thank God. I mean, until now, there has never been anything, I don't know, I don't know, I can even say a wrong, a bad word, I mean, nothing has happened to me from my husband in any way. I mean, what else can I compare such a marriage with? Well, sometimes yes, there are points where we clash, maybe things happen. They are the spice of life, that's all that happens. (laughs)

Speaker 1 [00:11:12] On which issues do you conflict?

Speaker 2 [00:11:15] I mean, something like this happens, for example, when I say conflict, I mean that sometimes in the things you say that you should do- I am a little impatient person. For example, the moment I say do this now, I want it to be done at that moment. Well, you know, when I say it once or twice, and the third time it's okay or something like that, now I'm experiencing the same thing with my children. I think it's because of my impatience though. You know, when it's not done at that moment, I always throw myself away. You know, once it's done, it's done. This time they are like, okay, we were going to do it, or something like that, or when I say, "Oh, you should have done it". This means that in some things (laughs) we clash a little bit on work-related issues. I

think it's a little bit of a thing, but I think my husband doesn't attempt it because he knows that I can do everything, not because of indifference, but because he knows that if he doesn't do it, I will do it very well. I think I gave him something like that from the beginning. (Laughs)

Speaker 1 [00:12:35] What do you mean by work? Are we talking about everyday things? Everyday is my word.

Speaker 2 [00:12:40] Everyday, how should I put it. I mean something that needs to be done in the house. For example, it can be a small renovation, a repair. So it is not done as soon as I say it. When I try to do it, he gets up and comes to do it himself, I say you don't do it when I tell you, you get up and come when I try to do it. I mean, what's wrong with that? I mean, we are a little bit conflicted on those issues.

Speaker 1 [00:13:08] Do you have any other difficulties?

Speaker 2 [00:13:11] I don't seem to have any other difficulties.

Speaker 1 [00:13:18] Are there times when your conflicts turn into fights and arguments?

Speaker 2 [00:13:22] No, never. I mean, as I just said, it didn't turn into a fight or a conflict, either he withdraws himself or I withdraw myself so that it doesn't turn into a fight or a conflict.

Speaker 1 [00:13:38] Someone takes it down. At that moment someone is undercutting.

Speaker 2 [00:13:44] Of course, exactly like that.

Speaker 1 [00:13:48] How often do you think you clash?

Speaker 2 [00:13:50] Sir?

Speaker 1 [00:13:52] How often would you say you clash?

Speaker 2 [00:13:57] I mean, not very often, I would say once in a while. I mean not very often.

Speaker 1 [00:14:04] Once a week, once a month, once a day, once a year?

Speaker 2 [00:14:08] Oh no, no, once every [1-5] months, once every [1-5] months.

Speaker 1 [00:14:16] How do you resolve your conflicts?

Speaker 2 [00:14:17] Our solutions?

Speaker 1 [00:14:19] Hmm your solutions?

Speaker 2 [00:14:23] I mean, like I said, when he calms down, you know, look, you did it like this, but this shouldn't be like this. I mean, you know, when I try to do it myself, he says that you are impatient and well, I say, you know, at least you know this harmony. Do this when I tell you. Do it immediately or at least take a step about what we are going to do. And they sometimes say to me that everything may not happen immediately when you want it. We make it sweet like that, but something like this happens, I am usually the one who takes the step.

Speaker 1 [00:15:08] Could you elaborate a bit more?

Speaker 2 [00:15:11] It's like this, in some things, for example, my husband, how can I tell you?

Speaker 1 [00:15:15] Say it as it comes.

Speaker 2 [00:15:19] I don't want to call it stubbornness, but for example, he shuts himself off, if you don't talk to him, he doesn't talk to you for [1-5] month, he won't talk. He has such a structure. But of course I can't stop. After a day, after a day, immediately. I mean, I approach him in a nice, loving way, with a nice word or a nice gesture. If he doesn't want to, I'll go and sit next to him. Well, he does that, but usually I'm the one who takes the step.



Speaker 1 [00:15:54] Apart from stepping in, apart from taking steps, what are the other ways to maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:16:04] Can you explain how? Our relationship-

Speaker 1 [00:16:08] I can ask, what do you do to maintain, to have a positive relationship to maintain a positive relationship, other than conflict resolution, other than conflict resolution, what ways do you use?

Speaker 2 [00:16:28] I mean, I don't know, I don't know how to put it, in what ways... I mean, I don't know if I'm trying to be nice all the time anymore. I think I'm trying to undercut everything so that there won't be a conflict somewhere. This is something that is a little bit in my nature. I'm constantly compromising myself. Maybe I don't know internally, maybe I'm internally resentful, but I'm constantly compromising myself.

Speaker 1 [00:17:05] What do you think love is?

Speaker 2 [00:17:08] Love is experienced, not explained.

Speaker 1 [00:17:12] I would like you to tell me.

Speaker 2 [00:17:14] You can't explain it, it's lived. I think love is excitement. I think love is a beautiful thing, but I think love is temporary, I can only say that love is an excitement. Because at a certain point you become a thing. Yes, even if you had a love marriage at first, but over time, you know, this love (aşk) also becomes love (sevgi). With love (sevgi), he becomes like a part of you. You feel like he is yourself. So there is an integration in your life. I don't know if I'm wrong now, but I think so, so love (aşk) ends. I think love (sevgi) remains after it ends. Children come in between, something happens. After the first beginning of your relationships, it becomes more differentiated after the children come into the picture. That interest and love (sevgi) is divided.

Speaker 1 [00:18:33] Naturally. How important is love for a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:18:39] How important? I think it's very important. I mean love (sevgi) is very important, respect is very important but love (aşk) is also important. I mean, I can say, I don't know, sometimes you want to experience that excitement like the first day.

Speaker 1 [00:19:02] Hmm what role does it play? Besides love (sevgi) and commitment, what makes love more or less important?

Speaker 2 [00:19:11] To my spouse?

Speaker 1 [00:19:13] No, what makes love important in relationships? I mean it's exciting, it's temporary, but why is it important?

Speaker 2 [00:19:25] Why is it important?

Speaker 1 [00:19:27] For you, I mean?

Speaker 2 [00:19:27] I mean, why is it important, how can I say it, I mean, do I have a hard time expressing it, I don't know what to say anymore, I mean, the excitement, I think that excitement disappears after a certain point. Or the person in front of you finishes that excitement, but I can't do much about it. Of course, this doesn't happen all the time, from time to time, yes, there are points where I feel excited, but sometimes when you are something, that excitement in you can disappear. It can take its own thing.

Speaker 1 [00:20:15] What can it take?

Speaker 2 [00:20:19] I mean, I don't know, when you are offended, is it your thing towards him? I mean, sometimes, as I said, I don't know if it comes to me because I give it. I mean, when something small happens, you expect the other person to take a step, you always expect the other person to take a step, when something goes away from you, sometimes these things can do something to people, even if it is small.

Speaker 1 [00:20:50] It consumes.

Speaker 2 [00:20:52] It seems to consume, yes. Otherwise there is no problem otherwise.

Speaker 1 [00:21:00] How do you know if your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:21:07] How do I know if my partner loves me; with a touch, with a look.

Speaker 1 [00:21:15] Can you explain a little bit more?

Speaker 2 [00:21:23] I mean for example, holding my hand while we are walking together or putting a kiss on my cheek while standing anywhere. Actually, there is also something like this, you know, we women maybe do, but it is a little bit difficult for men to say this love (sevgi). I don't know what they think will happen when they tell the other person that they love (sevgi) them, do they think they will be spoiled, what happens? I experience this all the time. Sometimes I use it very often with my husband. I use the word "I love you", sometimes I even ask, do you love me? And then he says "what am I doing with you if I don't love you?" I mean, sometimes I say I want to hear that. I mean, it doesn't mean anything after I say it. Yes, I know you're with me. You're with me because you love me. And I love you because we get along well, but sometimes you really want to hear it.

Speaker 1 [00:22:32] Well, you said that you can understand love with a touch, a look, a kiss without hearing it, but you also said that it is not enough, it needs to be put into words.

Speaker 2 [00:22:56] Yes. I don't know if the other side thinks that they will lose meaning in what they say. I don't know what he thinks, I think the meaning gains more meaning.

Speaker 1 [00:23:17] What are the most important things in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:23:24] The most important thing in a relationship is mutual trust. Respect. Well, I think it is, how can I say it, a proper mutual relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:23:43] What does that mean, a proper relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:23:50] Well, now (laughs) how should I say it, let me explain. I mean, this is a complete thing, you know, in my mind, not as a thing, I mean, I can also consider it as a sexual life.

Speaker 1 [00:24:10] Do you mind if I ask about sexual life while we're on the subject?

Speaker 2 [00:24:14] Sir?

Speaker 1 [00:24:16] While we're on the subject, do you mind if I ask you two questions about your sex life?

Speaker 2 [00:24:21] Ask.

Speaker 1 [00:24:22] How often do you have sexual intercourse?

Speaker 2 [00:24:26] How many years?

Speaker 1 [00:24:28] Right now, these days. How often do you have sexual intercourse?

Speaker 2 [00:24:35] Oh how often. I mean once a week.

Speaker 1 [00:24:38] Once a day, once a week, once a month, once a year.

Speaker 2 [00:24:43] Like once in ten days, I mean I would say once a week at most, not twice.

Speaker 1 [00:24:54] Are you satisfied with your sex life?

Speaker 2 [00:24:59] Ya- I mean.

Speaker 1 [00:25:03] Would you like to elaborate a little more? What are you satisfied with and what are you not satisfied with?

Speaker 2 [00:25:12] On my own behalf, I don't know how to put it.

Speaker 1 [00:25:19] I am asking on your behalf, exactly.

Speaker 2 [00:25:23] On my behalf?

Speaker 1 [00:25:27] Say it as it comes.

Speaker 2 [00:25:32] I can say something like this. Well, [redacted].

Speaker 1 [00:26:29] How is your satisfaction and dissatisfaction in the relationship? I mean you said, you said that you are not always very enthusiastic when you have intercourse, even when you have intercourse.

Speaker 2 [00:26:42] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:26:44] How does this affect your satisfaction, how does this affect your satisfaction or dissatisfaction?

Speaker 2 [00:26:57] Hmmmm now I don't understand but let me tell you what. I mean, sometimes, as I said, it's like this, sometimes something like that happens. Even if I wanted it myself, there are points where it is exactly like that. Even when you first want it yourself in a union, I mean, I can't get any pleasure from that sexuality even like that. I don't know if this is probably related to the fullness of my head, but it happens sometimes. Sometimes there are times when it's good. And when this happens, I try not to show it to my husband that I am reluctant. Just to make him happy, I know that maybe I'm making a mistake. Sometimes when something happens, I say, "Look, why am I like this?" I blame myself. Maybe I need a treatment for this, but we always postpone it. Maybe we hesitate - I don't know if we hesitate anymore, but when we talk about such things now, I mean now.

Speaker 1 [00:28:16] Sexuality is a difficult subject to talk about in [Country].

Speaker 2 [00:28:20] That's actually true. Yes, exactly as you say.

Speaker 1 [00:28:23] It is a subject we are afraid of in the context of our country, a subject we are not used to.

Speaker 2 [00:28:27] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:28:29] It is also a fragile subject. Because it is a very intimate subject, it is a subject that can be broken and hurt.

Speaker 2 [00:28:40] Well, as you just asked, when you said, yes, at first I said it hesitantly, but yes, sexuality is a very important role in marriage. It is really very important. How should I tell you, even if it's a marriage, you feel good about yourself personally. I mean, it is a very giving thing when you have sexuality. You also feel very good about yourself. Maybe you feel lighter by understanding some of your own things, some things inside you. Well, since I can't experience this all the time, like I said, for example. You know. Let's say it happens sometimes. Okay, my husband. He tries to be good to me, but sometimes it happens. He's finished before I can do anything. I can't do this job.

Speaker 1 [00:29:39] It's over before you have an orgasm, he has an orgasm.

Speaker 2 [00:29:43] That's exactly what happens and you can't voice them. Sometimes, for example, it was like this. When I said E, sometimes I blamed myself a lot, not even now, but at a certain period. Let's say maybe [1-5] year ago, I know that I even sat and cried when I blamed myself for some things related to this. (Laughs) Actually, I wasn't thinking about myself at that moment. Maybe not because I was thinking about myself. I think the reason is that I have a structure, you know, the other party, myself, I don't know what this means, but I don't value myself too much. I care more about my partner.

Speaker 1 [00:30:32] I can say something about that too. Sexuality is not to be experienced selfishly, it is a state that is enjoyable when it is experienced. It needs to be left within, when you live for yourself, you can only experience those feelings, those pleasures. It is not easy if your mind is on the other side. It has a selfish side. Embracing that selfishness, embracing that selfishness can be very useful.

Speaker 2 [00:31:08] Making the other person a thing?

Speaker 1 [00:31:11] No, I mean expressing and practicing your sexual desires, your own demands, your own needs.

Speaker 2 [00:31:17] Yes, yes

Speaker 1 [00:31:23] (continues) announce. Sexuality is a selfish act by definition.

Speaker 2 [00:31:29] Exactly.

Speaker 1 [00:31:31] It is a space where one is alone with one's own desires. It is what we do for ourselves in those moments, what we express, what we put into action.

Speaker 2 [00:31:41] So now it's like this, as you said, the other person, the human being, the best human being, knows their own body best. So okay, you can direct the other person or the other person, or I can say at the point of lovemaking. I don't know what kind of things they enjoy more with your partner, what kind of things they enjoy more with touching, what they practice when they see this, I don't know if it is a little bit related to the other person, but I don't know if we are going to different points. You warn me too. I mean, it's something like that. But there is something like this, I don't know about sexuality, I don't know, maybe it's something I've experienced before, sometimes I wonder if I was always like this, sometimes I wonder if it became like this later. I mean, in my [20-25] years and [6-10] months of marriage, I think maybe half and half? I have a sexual life that I fully enjoy myself. But I'm telling you, I always blame myself for some things this time. There is also something like this, I mean, I can't talk to my husband about some things like this. In such ways, you just said that the points of conflict are mutual. For example, when I try to talk, when I have something to say, he says two words and leaves it. He puts something there for you, he builds a wall. So you can't go beyond that, even if you want to ask, you can't ask. What do I do this time - when I do, I have to withdraw myself this time. Because you can't go any further and get something. You know, you can't get the answer to what you are asking. In such things, there are points where I become much more closed in myself.

Speaker 1 [00:34:08] How does this affect your conflicts? You opened it from the context of your conflicts. We came from sexual life to not being able to talk, from not being able to talk to conflict.

Speaker 2 [00:34:20] It's not about sexuality, it's also things that happen in our normal life, for example, I ask something. He gives an answer, right? When I ask a question again from the answer you asked, it's a question, so why are you asking question after question? We always come to such a thing. Then I ask questions again and again because I can't get an answer to the question you gave me, the question I asked. I mean, how should I put it, you know, it's not like you're waiting for an answer, not like you're going to understand what I'm talking about. Because I can't get a clear answer that satisfies me, I keep asking. This time, when they say, "Why are you asking question after question?" I get offended. I withdraw myself. I don't get an answer to the question I asked, I

just leave it alone. I mean, sometimes it's like, how should I put it? It happens sometimes in, you know, sexual life sometimes. You say do it, my relationship is over, and then you know, standing on the sidelines in a hopeless way. I mean, the thing comes to you sometimes, there are times when I feel, you know, like interest, normally he does something, you know, the relationship ends and then he lets himself go. There is no interest again. There were many times when I wondered if I was becoming something. I just wonder if he sees it as a means of sex. When it ends at that moment, I don't know because I'm not, for example, I don't know after that relationship. But I can say that before, I can say that recently, since about [1-5] years ago, he has been a little better in this regard. At least he hugs me again. You know, he does things, he touches, but I can say that he was acting a little more desperate before. I mean, I don't know if it was related to his advancing age, he wasn't much before. Now, for example, lately, he's been, I don't want to say he's been on me a little bit more, but he seems to want to do everything with me. Sometimes, I mean, I want to go somewhere, he says okay, come on, let's go. You know, Let me go with my friends. It wasn't like this before, for example. I used to say to him, you know, you didn't stand by me when I was young and you traveled with your friends, so let me go now, I mean don't squeeze me too much. But now, since these last [1-5] or [1-5] years, I believe that he has shown more interest in me.

Speaker 1 [00:37:13] Now that we're on the subject, has this relationship changed you too? We were talking about changes.

Speaker 2 [00:37:20] His attitude towards me?

Speaker 1 [00:37:21] Let's talk about you first and then we'll talk about your partner. Did this relationship change you?

Speaker 2 [00:37:27] Okay, I mean in the way they have changed towards me over the last couple of years, yes, I would say it has changed me too.

Speaker 1 [00:37:32] How have you changed?

Speaker 2 [00:37:34] Well, I don't know, I feel better. I mean, at least after that relationship I don't feel like I've been thrown away when it happened. I feel more cared for. I mean, I feel more valuable.

Speaker 1 [00:38:00] In what ways would you say you have changed since the beginning of your relationship? How you have changed.



Speaker 2 [00:38:06] Me from the beginning?

Speaker 1 [00:38:08] Exactly, so over the course of the past [26-30].

Speaker 2 [00:38:14] But you know, things like I said, you know, when things happen at certain points, you know, I said, when there are times when he pulls away, yes, I didn't always feel myself, of course, I mean, normally in our sexual relationship, in normal things in the relationship, you know, not always in our sexual relationship, although there are things that we sometimes clash, but over time, I can say that since these last [1-5] to [6-10] years; yes, I think our relationship has gotten a little better. I don't know, is it because my husband's personality has become more established or is it because we have both reached a certain age? It could be that too. Maybe as people get older, they experience the fear of losing each other more, so they may fall on each other more. I mean, I think so, because it's like that, you know, after a certain point, people have a fear of losing each other. I mean....

Speaker 1 [00:39:14] Hmm fear of being alone.

Speaker 2 [00:39:17] Actually this should be always, not at a certain age. It should be for all time actually. That fear of loss should be there every moment.

Speaker 1 [00:39:27] Is the person you were before the relationship the same person you are now? If different, how is it different?

Speaker 2 [00:39:34] Before the relationship?

Speaker 1 [00:39:37] How is the person you were and the person you are now different? Is it different? How has your relationship just changed, uh, how has your relationship just changed-

Speaker 2 [00:39:49] Changed?

Speaker 1 [00:39:51] No, I'm asking how you have changed, how have you changed as an individual in this relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:40:02] Well, when you say how I have changed in this relationship, it's his attitude towards me. You know, a little more insignificance.

Speaker 1 [00:40:16] Well, I think we are getting confused. It is not what happened that you changed, how did you change?

Speaker 2 [00:40:25] How did I change?

Speaker 1 [00:40:26] How did you change? How did you change and in what way?

Speaker 2 [00:40:30] I can say something like this. Before, for example, maybe, although not much happened when this happened. For example, when he hugs me when he comes, I feel more excited... You know, I feel more excited when he hugs me. I do something more for the lovem (sevgi) he has for me. When we sit down, for example, we can have better conversations on some issues. Before, we couldn't do such things so much. So we can have longer conversations on some topics now.

Speaker 1 [00:41:10] I'm not asking about your relationship, I'm asking about yourself. You?

Speaker 2 [00:41:12] Me? I'm happier.

Speaker 1 [00:41:16] I'm asking these things like being happier, more flexible, more cheerful.

Speaker 2 [00:41:20] Yes. I'm more cheerful, I'm happier, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:41:22] How have you changed?

Speaker 2 [00:41:25] If you explain a little more, you know what I'm saying.

Speaker 1 [00:41:27] Yes yes

Speaker 2 [00:41:28] Yes, a little bit more yes that's it. I'm more cheerful, I'm happier, I feel better.

Speaker 1 [00:41:35] How has your husband changed? In what ways has he changed?

Speaker 2 [00:41:39] In what ways has my husband changed? Well, how can I say, maybe he started to show more love that he was not showing. I mean, I don't know, when he came home from work, there were times when he would just come in and sit down. For example, now I'm at home, for example, even if I'm in the kitchen, it makes me feel good when he hugs me when he comes to the kitchen. I mean, wherever I am, he comes and talks to me, gives me a hug, kisses me. Some days, yes, there is a lot of change.

Speaker 1 [00:42:22] Would you say that you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:42:26] Safe?

Speaker 1 [00:42:29] Safe.

Speaker 2 [00:42:31] Yes. At least safer now. Hopefully it will be even better. (Laughs)

Speaker 1 [00:42:42] Can you explain a little bit why you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:42:45] I mean, I am saying that there are changes, you know, as a change of something that happened a long time ago, you know, these changes or maybe even my talking to you right now may have added something to me. Maybe some of the things that I couldn't express to my husband I can express better to him. I would rather say for a better relationship for this marriage. Because I don't have any problems in my marriage, thank God. You know, for the relationship between us that is different. By talking together, we can take things in a better direction. I have such a thought. Maybe this is the first time I've talked to you about these things, as you just said, unfortunately, in [Country], whether it's sexuality or something else, when these are topics that cannot be talked about... Look, this is the first time I'm talking to you about something like this right now and maybe this has somehow relieved me. If I can talk about this with you, I think maybe I can talk more comfortably with my husband.

Speaker 1 [00:43:53] Why not?

Speaker 2 [00:43:55] I mean.

Speaker 1 [00:43:57] Right? I have a question on a couple of scales. I shared a screen for this. If that's okay with you. Let me find it. Yes, do you see it?

Speaker 2 [00:44:24] Do I see it? I see it.

Speaker 1 [00:44:26] I'm going to read it anyway, but I shared it because it might be useful for you to see it. My partner usually listens to me-

Speaker 2 [00:44:36] Yes he listens.

Speaker 1 [00:44:39] (continues) if I ask you. How many would you say from not true at all, 1 not true at all to 9 completely true?

Speaker 2 [00:44:50] Completely true, he listens.

Speaker 1 [00:44:54] Did you answer listening as listening to the word or did you answer listening as listening? In our language both are used. I realized that there is something like that here.

Speaker 2 [00:45:07] Oh, I see. No, I said it in terms of listening to things that need to be done.

Speaker 1 [00:45:14] Otherwise, can I ask for the sake of listening?

Speaker 2 [00:45:17] In terms of listening in other ways, I can't say exactly. I mean, as I just said, in some of the questions I ask, he can silence me in some places because I can't go any further because he builds a door.

Speaker 1 [00:45:36] How many would you give from 1 to 9?

Speaker 2 [00:45:39] I would give 5 from one to nine.

Speaker 1 [00:45:47] Why 5 and not 4?

Speaker 2 [00:45:50] Why 5 and not 4? Because 4 is too low.

Speaker 1 [00:45:56] What would you give 4?

Speaker 2 [00:45:58] So, sir?

Speaker 1 [00:46:00] What would you give 4?

Speaker 2 [00:46:05] I mean, I would probably say 4, if he didn't make me talk at all.

Speaker 1 [00:46:11] What would you say to 1 then?

Speaker 2 [00:46:14] 1? I would say 1 if he doesn't even look at me. (Laughs)

Speaker 1 [00:46:28] Okay. If I asked you, my partner is usually sensitive to my needs; 1 is not true at all, 9 is completely true. How many would you give?

Speaker 2 [00:46:35] Sensitive to my needs, you're asking about relationship purpose.

Speaker 1 [00:46:45] Your needs can be anything.

Speaker 2 [00:46:47] Against my needs-

Speaker 1 [00:46:50] You may need a hug, you may need him to stay, you may need him to take the child to school, needs, needs... Human needs are many.

Speaker 2 [00:46:59] Oh yeah, how much would I pay for that?

Speaker 1 [00:47:04] How much for that?

Speaker 2 [00:47:06] I'll give 8.

Speaker 1 [00:47:09] Why 8 and not 7?

Speaker 2 [00:47:14] So that's it. I mean, when I do it in general.

Speaker 1 [00:47:26] Why 8 and not 9?

Speaker 2 [00:47:29] Let me say he's not quite perfect. (Laughs)

Speaker 1 [00:47:43] Hmm can you give an example of a moment when you were listened to and your needs were met? I mean being heard, feeling heard, being listened to and having your needs met.

Speaker 2 [00:47:58] Now what you call needs, for example, you just mentioned, you know, taking your child to school, I don't know. You know, when I say something about children, if there is a problem with them, if he needs to solve it, he solves it. It's the same way with me, when I ask for something, he doesn't refuse what I ask for. How can I tell you what it is? I mean, I don't know, whether it's a trip or something you need to buy, you know, if there's a need for something like that. So at that moment I can say that even if there is nothing, even if there is not only financial power, I shouldn't say that, but even if there is not, somehow something will come out of it.

Speaker 1 [00:48:48] So what about your emotional needs?

Speaker 2 [00:48:51] If we talk about our emotional needs, I shouldn't say too much in emotional relationships. I mean, these days, yes, I say it's going well, but I don't want to be unfair to him, it's not that much. (Laughs)

Speaker 1 [00:49:16] Hmm okay. If I ask you how satisfied you are with your relationship in general: completely dissatisfied, very dissatisfied, somewhat dissatisfied, not sure, undecided, somewhat satisfied, very satisfied, completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:49:38] Now if I say I am fully satisfied, you will say why. (Laughs) A little bit dissatisfied, a little bit.

Speaker 1 [00:49:49] Do we say a little bit dissatisfied or a little bit satisfied?

Speaker 2 [00:49:53] I am a little bit dissatisfied. I'm mostly satisfied, not a little bit.

Speaker 1 [00:49:58] You are mostly satisfied, you are very satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:50:01] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:50:08] A little bit less than completely.

Speaker 2 [00:50:11] Exactly, a little less than full.

Speaker 1 [00:50:16] Minus 10 completely, that's not it. 0 means not satisfied at all, 10 means completely satisfied; what would give your satisfaction?

Speaker 2 [00:50:29] 0 not at all.

Speaker 1 [00:50:30] 10 completely. Exactly 0 not at all, 10 completely.

Speaker 2 [00:50:33] I would give 10.

Speaker 1 [00:50:45] You are angry but should I ask why not 9?

Speaker 2 [00:50:51] (Laughs) I just said, I think it's because there is a little bit less than full. I mean, no matter how much we want to, none of us are perfect. We definitely have little mistakes. So let's say it's the spice of life. There are some small things, but of course, even if the minus is small, the pros are much, much more, the pros are much, much more.

Speaker 1 [00:51:30] Then we are done.

Speaker 2 [00:51:32] Are we finished?

Speaker 1 [00:51:36] I would like to summarize what we talked about.

Speaker 2 [00:51:42] Actually, you will evaluate what you have done as a scale yourself, if you evaluate me a little bit against me. (Laughs)

Speaker 1 [00:51:47] I am not going to do an evaluation. This is, we are part of the research, but they will divide the analysis of the research into themes, using an interface, using an application. They will make a thematic analysis, which we will not do. But I would like to summarize so that if there is something I misunderstood, if there is something you want to add, if there is something missing... So that I know that I understand everything correctly and you have the opportunity to add something if you want to add something.

Speaker 2 [00:52:34] Okay, okay.

Speaker 1 [00:52:35] You are [50-55] years old. You've been together for [26-30] years. You have [1-5] children, [20-25] and [20-25] years old. You live with your wife and daughter.

Speaker 2 [00:52:44] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:52:44] You are retired. Your husband is also retired, but he continues to work. When I asked, "How did you meet?" you said that you had an arranged marriage. When you were [20-25], you were in [City A] and he was in [City B]. In fact, you said that you never looked at your husband in [City B] or thought about it, but after these conversations, he said that he would call you on the phone, and when he called you on the phone, he asked you to marry him, and you agreed to marry



him, contrary to your own expectations, that you fell in love when you saw him, that he was very good for you, that he made you forget your previous experiences.

Speaker 2 [00:53:26] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:53:26] So you mentioned that your relationship progressed quickly from meeting to marriage. You mentioned that you were engaged within [1-5] month and married [1-5] months later. When you compared the quality of the relationships around you with the quality of your own relationship, when we asked you about your comparison, you said that you found your relationship better. You said that the relationships around you can have paths that lead to violence. You said that you don't have these things. You mentioned that the fact that one side knows how to stop is an important part of the quality of your relationship. You mentioned that somehow the woman gets her way. You said that this also contributed to your own good quality. When I asked, "What makes a relationship of high quality?" you said trust and respect. You said respect breeds love. You more or less said that without trust, you look for ulterior motives, even if you didn't say those exact words. When I asked, "What makes low quality?" you said selfishness, indifference and insensitivity. I added insensitivity, but you seemed to want to say insensitivity.

Speaker 2 [00:54:45] Yeah, I mean, maybe a little bit in the words I use, yes, exactly as you say, right.

Speaker 1 [00:54:53] Okay, let me close that so that we can continue the face-to-face interview. When I asked you, "Would you compare it with your previous relationships, how would you compare it?" you said that your relationships as a child were not exactly relationships anyway, that you had [1-5] serious relationship before your spouse, that you could not evaluate, compare or compare it, and that if you came back to this life again, you would choose to marry your spouse again. You said that there is no comparison. You said that when your wife met the gentleman from your former relationship, she thanked him for leaving you with her.

Speaker 2 [00:55:34] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:55:35] How about conflicts... When we talked about conflicts, you said that you usually have conflicts on the basis of what needs to be done in daily work, that you are impatient, that when you say something, you want it to be done immediately, and they don't always do it, and that you have conflicts in these contexts, that there is a lot of impossibility in the air. You said that you never argued, that the arguments never turned into fights. You said that if we clash every [1-5] months, every [1-5] months, we are clashing. Exactly, you mentioned that your spouse left you work because you could do everything, in a sense, you mentioned that they locked you out of work.

So when I asked, "What are the ways you use to maintain the relationship?" you talked about giving of ourselves. That you don't prioritize yourself, you always prioritize others. You mentioned that you do this often, even though it sometimes leads to vulnerability. You talked about being a giver. So you talked about the importance of giving to sustain a relationship. I asked, "What is love?" We talked a little bit about love. You said it is excitement, you said it is temporary, you said it turns into love and does not last. You said that people integrate, become one. So love doesn't stay, love. Love turns into other things, at first. You described it as such a violent excitement, like a heart palpitation if I understood you correctly. You said it was very important. You said that people look for that initial excitement even afterwards. You said that you like it when it is repeated. Is there anything you would like to add so far?

Speaker 2 [00:57:38] No, I think that's it.

Speaker 1 [00:57:40] Okay, let's continue. I asked, "How do you know that the other person loves you in a relationship?" You said, "You can tell with a touch, a look, sitting next to you, a kiss." You also mentioned that you want it to be said. You said that this is not enough, that you want to hear it. You said what you want to hear. When we talked about the most important factors, the most important things in a relationship, we talked about mutual trust, again mutual respect and sexuality. Then we talked a little bit about your sex life. We talked about having sexual intercourse once a week, once every [1-5] weeks. When I asked you about your satisfaction and dissatisfaction, you actually said half and half. Even though you said it later in the conversation. Well, you mentioned that you often have sexual intercourse to please your partner, that you have difficulty in expressing your satisfaction, your difficulties, the aspects that you feel are missing; that it causes problems for you at least. You said that you try not to show it to your partner. You said that you blame yourself a lot in this context.

Speaker 2 [00:59:08] Did I see myself as inadequate? I mean, I think I found myself inadequate in some things.

Speaker 1 [00:59:18] You said that you didn't value yourself very much. You said that the fact that your mind was often full, that it was busy, that there were things to do, responsibilities to fulfill, prevented you from indulging in sexual pleasures.

Speaker 2 [00:59:36] Yes, I did, you summarized it very well. I didn't put it that way, but yes, exactly.

Speaker 1 [00:59:43] In a sense, you explained that you cannot talk about everything with your spouse, that you have difficulties in conflicts in this context, that the channels of communication are not always fully open, that it is a problem for you. You told us that our communication was

closed, walls were built, sometimes your spouse withdrew. When we talked about how you changed, what changed, you mentioned that you felt more important, more valuable, more secure. You mentioned that your partner has become a person who can show love more easily. When I asked you whether you feel safe, safe, how safe you feel in this relationship. There are things I can do more by talking but you said you feel safe, you said we can talk. So you said that if I talk to you, I would probably talk to him too. Well, after that, we spent some time playing with scales. We played 9, 8, 7. That was our interview. How did it feel to summarize?

Speaker 2 [01:01:00] If I can help you...

Speaker 1 [01:01:04] Absolutely, absolutely you have been helpful. This is exactly the kind of conversation we needed. Is there anything you would like to add, is this right, is this wrong, is this missing, is there anything you would like to say?

Speaker 2 [01:01:19] No. I mean I can't think of anything right now.

Speaker 1 [01:01:23] Well, then we have two topics left. One, we have two bureaucratic procedural issues left. As you read in the consent form, you have three options on how we can use the data that you are sharing with us right now, that I have recorded. Even though it says two. One is to say don't use it, brother, I don't give permission. You can say that after 3 months, you can say that after 5 months. You can always change your mind about the use of your data. The other two options, one of them is that this interview, this online audio-video recording, will not leave my computer. I'll encrypt it, I'll store it on my computer, and it will only come out when. We will put this conversation on paper, that is, we will transcribe it. Your sentences will be transcribed.

Speaker 2 [01:02:32] I understand, you can give it in writing, not the interview.

Speaker 1 [01:02:35] Exactly, we will only use it in writing. We will de-identify this written form. In other words, we will purify it from your job, your age, where you live, the most obvious things that can be used to recognize and identify you. We will also remove things that can be sensitive. I mean, if we use it separately from your age, your name, your province, there are no things that can easily be associated with you. We can use this written transcript in two ways. One, I can only allow you to take extracts from it. You can use one paragraph of it, you can use two paragraphs of it and make it available, or you can be a little bit bolder and use the whole transcript, anonymized, de-identified.

Speaker 2 [01:03:39] You can use the whole thing in de-identified form. In writing.

Speaker 1 [01:03:44] In writing, absolutely.

Speaker 2 [01:03:46] Yes, in writing. I don't want it as an image, as a thing, you can use it in writing.

Speaker 1 [01:03:51] No that's not an option, it will only be used in writing. And all the analysis will be done on the texts.

Speaker 2 [01:04:00] Yes

Speaker 1 [01:04:01] Okay, thank you very much. For choosing the braver one, the more open one. This is contributing to us. One last thing. We are looking for a couple, as you guessed, that's why I met with you. I don't want to meet with people in your circle. We want to get away from them in a sense because they can't share comfortably. Suggest someone who can suggest a couple for us. You know what I mean? So you won't suggest the couple I'm going to meet or suggest a couple who might want to meet, if you can. You suggest someone who might know a couple who might want to meet. So you say [Name] can help you. We will go to [Name]. We will say [Name], do you know a couple who would like to meet with us?

Speaker 2 [01:04:51] Oh, I will not find you a couple.

Speaker 1 [01:04:54] No, no, you will find us [Name]. [Name] will find us a couple.

Speaker 2 [01:04:59] Is that how it should be? I can contact the couple directly if you want. I mean, if they agree, I can find them that way.

Speaker 1 [01:05:14] I'm not sure I should ask this because there is a reason why we are doing it this way:

Speaker 2 [01:05:24] Yes.

Speaker 1 [01:05:25] (Continues) I'm trying to reach a wider social network.

Speaker 2 [01:05:29] Reaching out yes.

Speaker 1 [01:05:31] So the wider, the wider social network we can reach, the easier it will be to generalize our findings. But your friends, the couples you want to talk to, the couples you want to talk to, maybe they can also help us to find couples.

Speaker 2 [01:05:57] Someone like that. I'm thinking, I'm thinking.

Speaker 1 [01:06:00] If he wants to participate, maybe he can find participants like you. You also wanted to participate and you could suggest participants.

Speaker 2 [01:06:08] It's like this, I wonder if she would participate herself, and of course to help you, for example, my daughter is doing something like this right now. I tell everyone, for example, something related to homework, can you help? I mean, I'll tell them about it. Mutual conversation, if you agree, like you said. Should I do something directly to you or should I inform you after talking to them directly?

Speaker 1 [01:06:36] Let's do it like this, talk to them, if there are people you can talk to, talk to them. If they approve, you tell them that I will call them or reach them and give me their information. Because your mediation is very important in such situations. When you tell me that you can talk to [Name] and you don't communicate with [Name], [Name] doesn't pick up my phone, and when he does, he goes poof. Your mediation is very functional. So reach out to him first and talk to him.

Speaker 2 [01:07:12] Right, yes, I understand. Okay, let me talk to him, like I said, maybe they won't accept it. If I give it to you now, it will be better if you can't call and reach them.

Speaker 1 [01:07:19] Exactly, there is no need.

Speaker 2 [01:07:21] I would also like to help.

Speaker 1 [01:07:24] I would be very happy.

Speaker 2 [01:07:25] Okay.

Speaker 1 [01:07:28] I'll end the call for a minute.